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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 2

Semester 1

Terms 1 and 2

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

Preciouslyours Pte Ltd, trading as Math Inquirers

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 1 of two booklets (Terms 1 and 2). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 1 and 2, the other booklet follows Semester 2 (Terms 3 and 4). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (5 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (0 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, drawn larger than real and in black and white.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Contents: Semester 1

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S1-01	P2-01	Hundreds, Tens, Ones	1 star
S1-08	P2-02	Column Sums	1 star
S1-09	P2-03	Mental Jumps	1 star
S1-12	P2-04	Equal Groups	1 star
S1-13	P2-05	Share It Out	1 star

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

What the booklet covers

Whole Numbers 1.2 number notation, representations and place values (hundreds, tens, ones) **S1-01**

Addition and Subtraction 2.1 addition and subtraction algorithms (up to 3 digits) **S1-08**

Addition and Subtraction 2.2 mental calculation involving addition and subtraction of a 3-digit number and ones/tens/hundreds **S1-09**

Multiplication and Division 3.1 multiplication tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10 **S1-12**

Multiplication and Division 3.2 use of ÷ **S1-13**

Multiplication and Division 3.4 multiplying and dividing within the multiplication tables **S1-12, S1-13**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.6; Multiplication and Division 3.3; Multiplication and Division 3.5; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 1.3; Fractions 2.1; Money 1.1; Money 1.2; Money 1.3; Money 1.4; Length, Mass and Volume 1.1; Length, Mass and Volume 1.2; Length, Mass and Volume 1.3; Time 2.1; Time 2.2; Time 2.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 3D Shapes 2.1; Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1.

S1-01 (P2-01)

Hundreds, Tens, Ones

★ Name _____

Topic: Place value: hundreds, tens and ones

Look at each item.
Write the number in the box.
Use the code table.

1

Hundreds	Tens	Ones
100 100 100 100 100	10	1 1 1 1 1 1 1

2

Hundreds	Tens	Ones
100 100 100	10 10 10 10 10	1 1

3

Hundreds	Tens	Ones
100 100	10 10	1 1 1 1 1 1 1

4 In 735, what is the value of the digit 5?

5 3 hundreds, 13 tens and 1 ones make which number?

6 8 hundreds, 0 tens and 9 ones make which number?

Code table

5 = N	227 = U	314 = Q	352 = O	431 = C
517 = B	523 = V	809 = E	980 = I	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-08 (P2-02)

Column Sums

★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract in columns, 3-digit numbers

Work out each sum in columns.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1

$$\begin{array}{r} 304 \\ +\ 219 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

2

$$\begin{array}{r} 433 \\ +\ 124 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

3

$$\begin{array}{r} 142 \\ +\ 294 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

4

$$\begin{array}{r} 722 \\ -\ 216 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

5

$$\begin{array}{r} 746 \\ -\ 594 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

6

$$\begin{array}{r} 648 \\ -\ 124 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

Code table

152 = C	406 = D	424 = Q	436 = U	506 = N
516 = K	523 = B	524 = E	557 = O	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-09 (P2-03)

Mental Jumps

★ Name _____

Topic: Mental sums: 3-digit numbers with ones, tens and hundreds

Start at START. Move up, down, left or right.
Step only on boxes with the answer 655.
Do not step on a box twice.

756 – 1	556 + 100	FINISH 585 + 70	254 + 400
575 + 60	695 – 40	647 + 8	625 + 30
656 – 1	642 – 7	676 – 20	255 + 400
START 455 + 200	653 + 2	855 – 200	660 – 5

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does every box make 655?

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S1-12 (P2-04)

Equal Groups

★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication: tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10

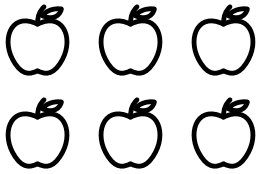
Find how many in all.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1 5 × 5 = ?

2 Hana has 2 groups of 5 pencils. How many pencils in all?

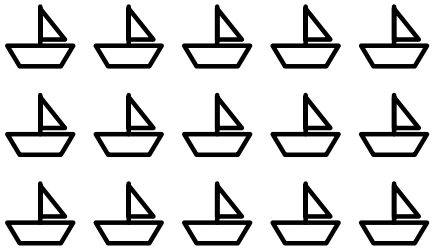
3 There are 4 tables. 9 children sit at each table. How many children?

4 How many apples in all?



5 5 × ? = 45

6 How many boats in all?



Code table

5 = X	6 = G	9 = I	10 = U	12 = Z
15 = E	24 = R	25 = B	36 = D	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-13 (P2-05)

Share It Out

★ Name _____

Topic: Division: sharing and grouping, the sign ÷

Share or group. Find each answer.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1 6 ÷ 2 = ?

2 32 ÷ 4 = ?

3 How many 3s are in 12?

4 12 marbles are shared equally among 2 children. How many does each child get?

5 70 eggs are put in boxes of 10. How many boxes are needed?

6 Kumar shares 27 grapes equally with 2 friends. How many does each person get?

Code table

2 = J	3 = C	4 = N	6 = O	7 = P
8 = A	9 = Y	13 = Q	24 = R	28 = W

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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